All the World's a Stage

Actor Adil Hussain is a travel junkie who loves getting lost—but not in a souvenir shop

How addicted exactly are you to travel?
I have loved travelling since I was a child. I am lucky that I travel for work and also by choice. I have visited many countries and enjoyed every place, but there is a special place in my heart for India. Our country is remarkable. The beauty of Assam, my home state, and its blue-green horizon is unforgettable.

Your most memorable trip?
From 1995 to 1996, I crisscrossed the country several times from top to bottom and across its breadth on my motorbike—so now you can understand my travelling passion. It was a fantastic experience and a huge learning for me. I love every bit of my country, the mountains, the beaches, the cities. If you ask me to choose the best part of the trip, I cannot. I'm in love with it all.

What do you enjoy most when you travel?
I don't like touristy stuff. Instead, I like to walk and get lost. I do not like to use the GPS or tourist maps. I never shop unless I find something I know someone I care about will love. What I really love is museums. On my first visit to Berlin I was in the city for four days and spent that entire time inside a museum. In retrospect, I should have seen more of the city!

Who is your favourite travel partner?
For the last 17 years since I have been married, it's my wife Kristen. She's an amazing companion.

During your travels, do you experiment with the local food or stay with a fitness plan?
Mostly I adhere to my diet to stay fit and maintain my weight. It's important both for my profession and health. When I travel, I avoid a heavy dinner and mostly stick to local vegetables.

with Shashi Sunny

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH